plans for a score-along. Calls are had and exceptions made and we, collaboratively with Sky, arrange for them to play back the entirety of the last day of Ben Stokes's Headingley innings against Australia. The idea is that we can relive it exactly as it went down, remembering how Test cricket used to hum around in the background of your day-to-day. In my case, it's the foreground, but it's interesting to view it with a fresh perspective and to start to realise how Test cricket works with people's imaginations – informing and feeding and offering escape for all who love it.

Before the score-along, we release a single on vinyl. I have designed the album artwork on my phone – a vague nod to The Maccabees' first single – with our illustrated heads dotting up in a row across the cover. Inside it, Mattchin does a spoken word poem about his Christmas single over some music Felix has made for *The Edge* film, and for the B-side, which we record a tender, passionate ode to Sharky's favourite cricketer: 'Allan Lamb', live on the podcast. We don't get the logistics in order in time, so the Christmas single comes out in March. It turns out that it's quite a genius piece of accidental marketing and charts at number five in the UK physical charts. It has words and the chords are not dissimilar to 'Everybody Hurts' by R.E.M. We are not thinking too much about any of it, but somehow the show has its own feeling and connection, and we come to realise that what we are recording is a group of people genuinely becoming good friends, noreal overthoughttoit, just astrange coincidence of lives turning an idea into a source of comfort that means so much to those who are listening to it.

After the score-along, we decide that Mattchin will host a quiz. He is fast becoming a cricketing cult hero, phoning into the show every week with more 'ideas' on how to make Test cricket more accessible or with quizzes – almost always entirely lifted from another TV gameshow, then renamed and loosely made about cricket. We encourage all of it even if I, knowingly, shrug and shun my way through his insistence on telling people that not only is Sachin Tendulkar his uncle, but Jimmy Anderson is his best friend too.

It is agreed that for the quiz, Mattchin should have access to my Instagram account as it has 1 million followers and because that way we can get the most 'eyeballs' on the quiz. I'm a bit dubious about it, but dutifully hand over the password and tell Mattchin to give it a go. I'm braced in trepidation during the score-along about how this will go down.